

# SHTUKA

## CAMPAIGN REPORT

Social Behaviour Change Radio  
Programmes – Southern Coastal  
Tanzania





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# EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report details the implementation and outcomes of the Shtuka Campaign, a Social Behaviour Change Communication (SBCC) initiative under the Foundations for Learning (F4L) Programme in Southern Coastal Tanzania. The campaign aimed to influence community attitudes and behaviours regarding education, focusing on crucial areas such as girls' education, parental involvement, budgeting for school needs, reducing corporal punishment, and addressing shifting farming practices. The campaign was implemented following insights from the Gender Responsive Social Behaviour Change Strategy and a rapid assessment. Studio 19's role involved developing a communication strategy and creating engaging content.

The campaign employed a multimedia approach, primarily leveraging radio due to its predominance in the target region, but also incorporating video drama. Key content formats included Radio Programs (Magazine Shows), Radio Dramas (Episodic Series), Radio Jingles & Public Service Announcements (PSAs), and Video Short Dramas (PSAs). The campaign produced a significant number of content pieces, including 16 Radio Jingles & PSAs, 32 Radio Magazine Shows, 24 Episodic Drama Series episodes, and 24 Video Drama episodes between July 2024 and April 2025. At Ruangwa FM and Mashujaa FM, a total of 64 radio episodes were aired (32 at each station).

Based on survey data, the campaign reached a large portion of the target population. Of 142 people engaged in the survey, 109 (77%) had listened to the Shtuka campaign via radio (61 men and 48 women). Applying this proportion to the total target population of 526,192 people in Lindi Municipal, Mtama, and Ruangwa Districts, the campaign is estimated to have reached approximately 403,677 people out of which around 226,059 are men and 177,618 are women. Direct engagement through radio interactions (call-ins and street interviews featured in episodes) is estimated at around 1,664 people across both main stations.

The campaign demonstrated clear signs of positive behaviour change and mindset shifts. Measurable changes reported by survey respondents included increased budgeting for education (46%, n=38/83), increased parental involvement (58%, n=48/83), and greater equal treatment for boys and girls in schooling (65%, n=54/83). Reduced harsh punishments (40%, n=33/83), return of pregnant girls to school (20%, n=17/83), formation of youth study groups, and shifts away from shifting farming practices were also noted. Radio programs were identified as the best performing format for driving behaviour change.



**Approximately  
403,677 People  
reached**



# INTRODUCTION

The Shtuka Campaign was developed in response to significant challenges in the quality and inclusiveness of pre-primary and primary education in Eastern and Southern African countries, including Tanzania. Large disparities in access and attainment persist due to socioeconomic backgrounds, geography, physical abilities, and gender. The COVID-19 pandemic further exacerbated these issues, leading to learning loss, decreased attendance, and increased dropouts.

Specifically in Tanzania, while the formalization of pre-primary education and mandatory free basic education have increased gross enrolment rates significantly (from 33% in 2014 to 78% in 2020), criticisms arose regarding the focus on enrolment over educational quality. Studies found that many children who completed pre-primary showed no more readiness for primary school than those who did not. Furthermore, despite free education policies, indirect costs like learning resources and uniforms pose a significant burden for low-income households, hindering sustained enrolment, particularly for children from rural, marginalised, and vulnerable groups. Quality barriers include insufficient infrastructure, high pupil-to-teacher ratios, and low teacher awareness of Early Childhood Education (ECE) pedagogy. Teacher and classroom shortages are a concern as enrolment grows.

In the target areas of Southeastern Tanzania, baseline findings revealed deeply rooted gender inequality, with women often assigned domestic roles and men perceived as more suitable for education and employment. While parents generally value education, household practices show a distinct gender bias, with boys' education often prioritised in resource-constrained households. Girls face significant barriers due to poverty and norms, including lack of resources like sanitary products and unsafe travel to school. At the primary school level, while some schools meet gender responsiveness standards, many face challenges with student absenteeism, low learning outcomes, and a gender gap in attendance and performance, with girls attending and performing worse than boys due to poverty, household responsibilities, and gender norms. The education system level shows deficiencies in stakeholder knowledge and skills regarding gender-responsive and inclusive education, insufficient teacher training, lack of learning materials, and staffing issues.

Addressing these challenges, the Shtuka Campaign's objectives align with the broader F4L programme's goal of enhancing equitable development and empowerment through a multi-dimensional approach to education system reform.



## **The campaign's objectives were:**

To create a strategy that guides content creation and distribution to effectively impact the 6 key target groups.

To create engaging content that challenges assumptions and norms, inspiring actions that enable children to enrol and stay in school.

# TARGET AUDIENCE

The campaign targeted several key audience groups based on analysis:



## Students

Students (Saidi Mtanda - 11-year-old boy, Mwanahamisi - 13-year-old girl),



## Teachers

(Sikuzani Malibiche - 32-year-old teacher),



## Parents

(Said Musa - 52-year-old father, Somoe Ngulangwa Mpota - 40-year-old mother),



## Older youth

(Sajuki Mohamedi - 18-25 years old, including Boda Boda drivers),



## Community Leaders

(Bakari Gome - 60+ years old),



## Education Officers

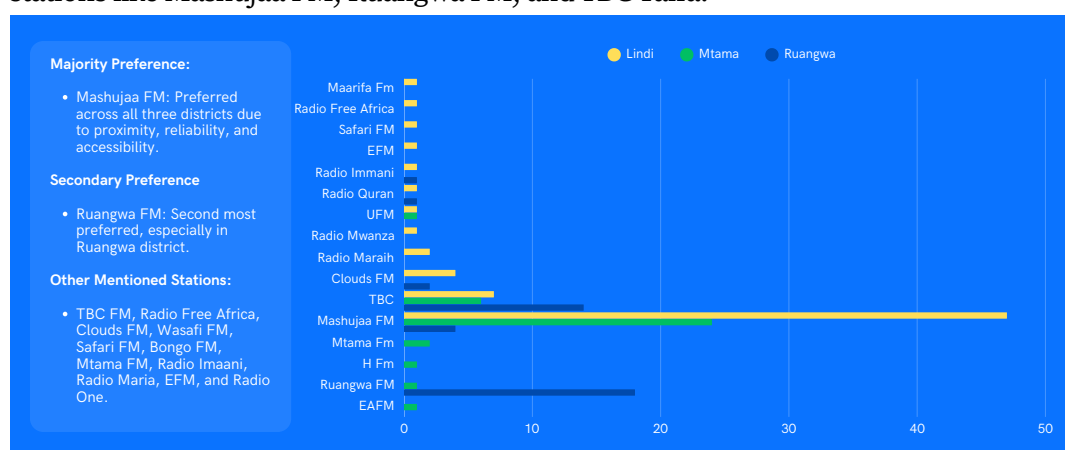
(Geoffrey Chilemba - 37-year-old DEO/Ward Education Officer).

# CONTENT STRATEGY

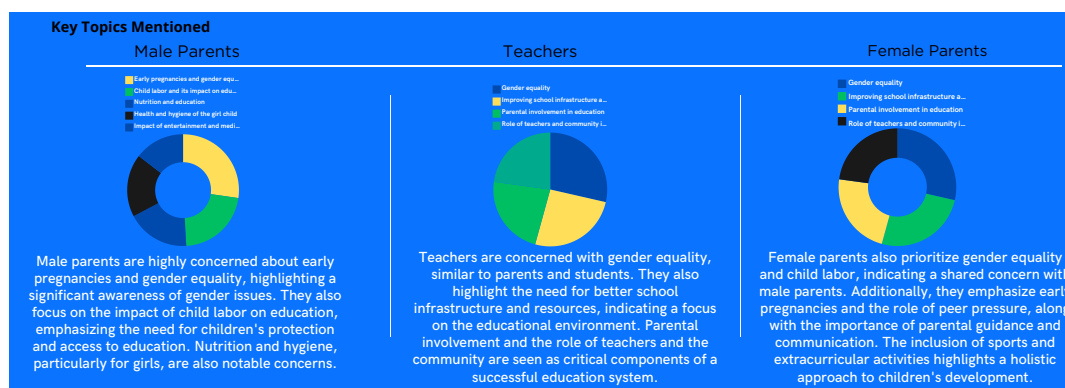
The content strategy for the Shtuka Campaign was developed to serve the goal of improving education quality, inclusivity, and gender responsiveness in Southeastern Tanzania, ultimately aiming for increased school enrollment and retention, particularly for girls. This strategy is explicitly grounded in data and information gathered from various sources, including the Gender Responsive Social Behaviour Change Strategy, the project's Inception Report, findings from a rapid assessment exercise, and a virtual assessment session with radio station managers.

## Rationale for Content-Based Approach

The rationale for employing a communication strategy based on diverse content formats stems from the understanding that influencing social behaviour requires reaching audiences through channels they habitually use and with messages tailored to their preferences and cultural contexts. Radio was identified as the predominant media of choice among the target groups in the Southern Coastal region of Tanzania, including Lindi, Mtama, and Ruangwa districts. Key insights from the rapid assessment highlighted significant listenership among various demographics, including youth, parents (male and female), and teachers, across popular radio stations like Mashujaa FM, Ruangwa FM, and TBC Taifa.



Furthermore, the rapid assessment revealed audience preferences regarding program types and timing. Popular programs included morning shows, evening programs, news, sports, entertainment, health, and radio dramas. The most popular listening times were early morning (6 am to 11 am) and evening (from 4 pm onwards). While children generally listen to radio less, they might tune into programs their parents listen to, and show a preference for cartoons and dramatic TV programs when available. Crucially, when asked about the best way to receive campaign messages, most respondents favored short jingles within popular programs and magazine shows combining talk shows, testimonials, experts, interactive sessions, and drama programs. Preferred durations were 1 minute for jingles and 30 minutes to 1 hour for full programs. The assessment also noted a rise in TV usage, particularly among certain groups for news and evening dramas.



## Media Selected:

**Radio**  
Mashujaa FM  
Ruangwa FM  
TBC Taifa

**TV Station**  
Azam 2

## TOPICS COVERED

The strategy also considered the specific topics preferred by different target groups, identified during the rapid assessment, to ensure content relevance. These topics ranged from food and nutrition for children, adolescent education, girl child health and hygiene (fathers' preferences) to effects of peer pressure, early marriages, parental involvement (mothers' preferences), importance of education, avoiding bad influence (boys' preferences), education for girls, health/hygiene, equality, career guidance (girls' preferences), interactive teaching methods, parental involvement, gender equality (teachers' preferences), and school accessibility, child safety, lack of parental responsibility (bodaboda drivers' preferences). This detailed understanding informed the content themes for each format.

### Season 1

| Focus Topics                     | # Episodes | # Jingles |
|----------------------------------|------------|-----------|
| Budgeting For Education          | 2          | 1         |
| Household Responsibility         | 2          | 1         |
| Parental Involvement             | 2          | 1         |
| Positive Peer Influence on Youth | 2          | 1         |

### Season 2

| Focus Topics                                                                  | # Episodes | # Jingles |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------|
| Creating a child-friendly environment for returning to school during holidays | 2          | 1         |
| The importance of education                                                   | 2          | 1         |
| Supporting school dropouts to return to school                                | 2          | 1         |
| Nutrition and food                                                            | 2          | 1         |
| Unproductive harshness                                                        | 2          | 1         |



### Season 3

| Focus Topics                                           | # Episodes | # Jingles |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------|
| Cooperation between teachers and parents               | 2          | 1         |
| Parental involvement in monitoring children's progress | 2          | 1         |
| Supporting children's talents                          | 2          | 1         |
| Youth support for students                             | 2          | 1         |
| Children's safety among relatives                      | 2          | 1         |
| Relatives' support in ensuring quality education       | 2          | 1         |





# Multiple Formats and Their Emergence

Based on these findings, the strategy proposed using a mix of media formats, acknowledging that no single radio program format could cater to all target audience groups due to their varied media habits and topic preferences. The selected formats emerged directly from audience feedback and their demonstrated effectiveness in engaging communities on sensitive issues:

## Radio Magazine Show

### Rationale:

Radio magazine shows were a core component of the campaign's communication strategy, offering a dynamic 45-minute format that combined studio talk shows, street dialogues, expert commentary, and thematic audio packages. This mixed-genre structure allowed for engaging, flexible delivery of key messages aligned with listeners' daily realities.

Each episode typically featured:

- **Talk shows** with local experts such as Educational Officers, Head Teachers, and Other Experts driving the topic. They also had the chance to respond to questions and Suggestions from the community.
- **Street Dialogues:** recorded twice monthly in community settings, captured spontaneous public perspectives on each topic. This offered real case studies and increased local ownership of the messages.

### Broadcasting & Reach:

32 episodes aired weekly, mid-morning with evening repeats, ensuring accessibility based on audience listening habits. Themes included child-friendly schools, education access, household budgeting, and peer influence.

### Engagement:

The format enabled real-time interaction via phone-ins and SMS, with strategic episode sequencing designed to sustain audience interest across broadcasts.

## Jingles

### Rationale:

Jingles are brief, catchy audio clips with high recall value, effective for reinforcing key messages through repetition and integrating into various popular programs. This format was recommended in the strategy and favoured by the majority of the target group audience for gaining attention.

### Number of Jingles:

16 distinct jingles/PSAs were proposed/produced (2 for each of the 8 key personas/groups).

### Voice Consistency:

To enhance continuity and recognition, the jingles used the same character voices as those featured in the radio drama series. This strategy helped build familiarity and strengthen message retention.

### Airing Schedule:

- Ruangwa FM & Mashujaa FM: Aired Monday to Friday, three times a day, during popular segments like breakfast shows, entertainment hours, sports programs, and around news bulletins.
- TBC (National Radio): Broadcast Monday, Wednesday, and Friday, providing wider national exposure alongside community-level reinforcement.

## **Radio Drama**

### **Rationale:**

Drama is a highly recommended format in the SBCC Strategy due to its emotional power and relatability. Through well-crafted characters and storylines drawn from real-life scenarios, drama effectively communicates complex social issues while keeping audiences engaged. It allows for behavior change messages to be absorbed in a subtle, memorable, and culturally resonant way.

### **Seasons and Episodes:**

A total of 24 episodes of approximately 15 minutes each were proposed and produced under the SHTUKA radio drama series. The episodes focused on themes such as girls' education, gender norms, child protection, economic hardship, parental support, and community accountability.

### **Airing Plan:**

Episodes aired as a weekly special program every Thursday on Ruangwa FM and Mashujaa FM, with a repeat every Friday night. This consistent slotting aligned with local listening patterns and increased reach. Selected episodes were also included in community listening sessions and school-based discussions.

### **Storyline**

The drama followed the lives of Nneka, Sadiki, Rehema, and Sada as they navigated challenges related to school, family, and society. Each episode addressed a specific behavior change theme.

## **Video Drama**

### **Rationale:**

Although radio is primary, video is increasingly preferred, especially for news and evening dramas. Short TV dramas in PSA form leverage this preference to reach audiences, particularly in urban areas and among education stakeholders. Drama's emotional engagement makes messages relatable and memorable.

### **Seasons and Episodes:**

24 episodes of 1 minute each were created, the story can also connect into one story that can be used as stand alone film.

### **Airing Plan:**

Aired during commercial breaks in popular soap operas on Azam 2, in the evenings (2100rs) three days a week Wednesday to Friday.

### **Storyline:**

Similar to radio Drama, the story follows the lives of Nneka, Sadiki na Rehema but the story line has been adjusted to fit the medium. It plays around the them of "Our dream" where it shows the aspirations of these young scholars and the challenges each face in the pursuit of their education. The challenges ranged from meals at school, negative influence from Bodaboda drivers and other youth, the role of order youth, Normadic farming and other challenges.



# Distribution and Dissemination

The campaign primarily used radio as the distribution medium, selected based on rapid assessment findings indicating it as the predominant media of choice across the target districts among all key target groups. The rapid assessment highlighted specific stations with significant listenership: Mashujaa FM, Ruangwa FM, and TBC Taifa. Radio programs were noted for high listenership in the early morning and evening.

## Report of reach:

Based on survey data where 76.76% of 142 respondents had heard the campaign, the scientifically estimated reach across the total population of 526,192 in the target districts (Lindi Municipal, Mtama, Ruangwa) is approximately 403,677 people.

## Location reached:

The Shtuka Campaign reached all 3 Targeted Districts: Ruangwa, Mtama and Lindi with at least 14 localities including Lindi Urban, Mtama, Ruangwa, Liwale, Nachingwea, Kilwa, Tandahimba, Newala, Masasi, Mbekenyerera, Likangara, Nandembo, Mandawa, and Mchinga. Ruangwa FM's coverage included Ruangwa, Liwale, Nachingwea, Masasi, Nanjilini, Mbekenyerera, Nandembo, and Likangara, while Mashujaa FM covered Lindi Urban, Mtama, Kilwa, Tandahimba, Newala, Mandawa, and Mchinga, as evidenced by call-ins and survey responses.

## Direct engagement:

Direct interactions through radio, based on monitoring 32 episodes aired at each station, included call-ins and street interviews. Ruangwa FM averaged about 40 engagements per episode (estimated 1,280 total), and Mashujaa FM averaged about 12 engagements per episode (estimated 384 total), resulting in an estimated total of ~1,664 people engaged directly through radio interactions.



## **Audience engaged:**

The Shtuka Campaign targeted the population across Lindi Municipal, Mtama District, and Ruangwa District. The campaign utilized various media formats, with varying degrees of success across age groups. Radio Programs were notably effective, reaching Adults, Parents, and Youth aged 18-35 years with high engagement. This aligns with the largest represented age groups in the survey data (26-35 years and 18-25 years). Radio Dramas and Jingles also engaged Parents, Community members, and the general public, reinforcing messages for adult audiences. The proposed communication strategy also noted that adults primarily listen to radio in the morning and evening, while boys and girls prefer evening/night, especially on weekends.

The survey suggest that younger children were not as well covered by the primary radio strategy. Most children do not listen to radio regularly, preferring TV programs like cartoons and dramas when possible. While the campaign did use TV Drama, it had low reach due to limited TV access, particularly in rural areas (need some more details on the fact potential impact among urban dwellers hence expanding the campaigns reach)



# Effectiveness of the Content

The survey and radio monitoring provided insights into the effectiveness of different content formats in reaching the audience and driving change.



## TV Drama:

Reached a much lower percentage (10–15% or 8–12/85) of respondents who had heard the campaign. Engagement was Low due to limited TV access, resulting in Minimal direct behaviour change reported. This format had Low penetration in rural areas.



## Radio Programs:

Reached 77% (n=109/142) of survey respondents who had heard the campaign. They showed high engagement (weekly follow-up, call-ins), strong behaviour change in budgeting and parental involvement. This was identified as the best performing format.



## Radio Dramas:

Reached 45% (38/85) of respondents who had heard the campaign. They generated Medium-High engagement, often eliciting emotional reactions. They were effective in improving attitudes toward girls' education and reducing corporal punishment, noted as being Highly relatable. One respondent testified, "The dramas convinced me to believe that a girl can become a great leader in the community."



## Jingles:

Reached 65% (55/85) of respondents who had heard the campaign. They showed Medium engagement (quick recall, repeated mentions). Jingles were effective in reinforcing core campaign messages, described as Good for awareness. A quote highlights this: "I started budgeting for my children's education after hearing the jingle 'Education is everything'."



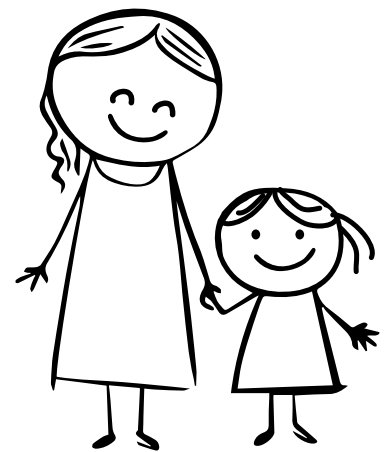


# Engagement and Impact

The campaign fostered significant engagement, primarily through radio call-ins and discussions featured in the magazine shows and drama series. The interactive nature of radio programs, incorporating talk shows, street dialogues, and testimonials, facilitated audience participation and feedback. These interactions provided real-time insights into listeners' perspectives and concerns.

Key behaviour change indicators observed and reported through survey data, testimonials, and radio monitoring included:

- Budgeting for education: 46% of survey respondents reported changes in this area, frequently raised by listeners during radio interactions.
- Increased parental involvement: 58% of respondents indicated this change, with strong evidence from call-ins and testimonials like "Dad now attends school meetings—it's no longer just Mom." One respondent noted, "I have started contributing money for school meals and monitoring my children's progress."
- Equal treatment for boys and girls in schooling: 65% of respondents reported changes, a theme strongly emphasised through the drama formats.
- Decrease in harsh punishments: 40% of respondents noted this change, addressed in radio dramas.
- Return of pregnant girls to school: Reported by 20% of survey respondents as a noticeable change in their communities.
- Formation of youth study groups: Described by respondents and supported through radio initiatives, observed through field recordings.
- Reduced shifting farming practices: While small in survey data, this shift was confirmed in radio discussions.



**"I have started contributing money for school meals and monitoring my children's progress."**

## Challenges and Lessons Learned

While the campaign was largely successful, several operational challenges were encountered that required adaptability and close coordination:

- **Guest No-Shows for Live Radio Talk Shows:** On some occasions, scheduled guests were unable to attend live sessions due to last-minute conflicts. This occurred twice in Season 1 and once in Season 2, all on Mashujaa FM, which aired at 10:30 a.m. Ruangwa FM, airing at 7:30 p.m., had no such incidents—possibly due to the more convenient timing. To manage no-shows, the team would either make an on-air announcement and reschedule the show within two days or air a pre-recorded backup episode. While this ensured continuity, it often reduced audience engagement, as pre-recorded segments lacked the opportunity for experts to respond to live listener questions or SMS feedback in real time.
- **Technical Difficulties at Broadcast Stations:** Partner station Mashujaa FM occasionally experienced technical disruptions, leading to delayed broadcasts—2 episodes were pushed to Thursday in Season 1, and 3 in Season 2. One episode in Season 3 was also delayed due to rain. In response, the station re-aired previous episodes or conducted remote interviews via Zoom, though this sometimes affected audio quality and listener experience. Ruangwa FM broadcasts were unaffected.
- **Need for Proactive Monitoring:** These issues emphasized the importance of active oversight and communication with media partners. The campaign team regularly tracked broadcast schedules, flagged issues, and worked closely with stations to resolve problems quickly and keep programming on track.





## **Lessons Learned:**

### **Radio's crucial role:**

Radio, particularly well-designed programs, dramas, and jingles, is the most effective medium for reaching large audiences and driving behaviour change in this context.

### **Importance of diverse formats:**

Using a mix of radio formats (magazine shows, dramas, jingles) caters to different audience preferences and keeps the messaging engaging and reinforces core themes.

### **Community involvement is key:**

Identifying audience preferences and local issues is crucial for effective message design and community engagement. Involving community members, experts, and positive deviants in content creation (e.g., testimonials, street dialogues) enhances relatability and credibility.

### **Capacity building:**

Addressing the weaknesses in local radio stations' capacity is essential for sustainable content production and quality broadcasting.

### **Sustained effort:**

Behaviour change is a gradual process, requiring repeated broadcasts and continued engagement.



## Recommendations

Based on the findings, the report offers several recommendations:

**Expand campaign reach:** Through more repeated broadcasts and extending coverage to new districts.

**Diversify formats:** Incorporate more real-life stories, dramas, and jingles based on their proven effectiveness.

**Strengthen youth empowerment:** Facilitate peer learning groups and initiatives that resonate with youth.

**Target fathers more effectively:** Design specific programs and interventions focusing on male engagement in education and household responsibilities.

**Sustain local messaging innovations:** Continue to use culturally sensitive approaches and carefully consider the use of local dialects.

**Invest in media capacity building:** Provide targeted training and support to local radio stations to improve production quality, genre diversity, and adherence to professional standards.



# Appendix

# Appendix 1: Rapid survey methodology

## Methodology

This chapter discusses the methodology utilized for the Shtuka Campaign survey, which aimed to assess community awareness, behavior change, and the effectiveness of communication formats. The survey employed a two-pronged approach, a primary data collection and a review of radio episodes.

**Assessment Area:** The assessment covered the Lindi Region, specifically focusing on the districts of Ruangwa, Mtama, and Lindi Urban, including surrounding villages. This area aligns with the target geographies of the Foundations for Learning (F4L) project.

**Respondents:** The survey participants were selected through purposive sampling. This sampling approach was applied to capture insights from a diverse range of stakeholders, including parents, teachers, youth, traders, farmers, religious and local leaders. Respondents were chosen to ensure diversity in gender, age, occupation, and geographic spread across the target districts.

**Data collection:** Data collection for the Shtuka Campaign survey involved structured interviews and the review of radio episodes.

**Structured Interviews:** The interviews were conducted using a Google Form tool. The questionnaire was designed with a combination of question types to gather both quantitative and qualitative data. This included Yes/No questions, short answer fields for brief open responses, and long answer fields for more detailed explanations and testimonies. These interviews provided quantifiable statistics and authentic testimonies.

**Radio Episode Review:** The methodology included monitoring and reviewing radio episodes from specific local stations. This involved reviewing 11 episodes from Ruangwa FM and 13 episodes from Mashujaa FM. The assessment points for the radio review included the volume and location of audience engagement, the themes discussed and their resonance with listeners, and observable behavior changes and emerging trends derived from real-time audience feedback. This monitoring validated claims and gauged public engagement in real-time.

**Data Analysis:** Descriptive analysis was done for the data collected from the field. Some questions were optional, so survey participants may have chosen to skip them. This resulted in varying denominators. The analysis was conducted among all respondents who answered each question. Thematic content analysis was done from the data collected from review of radio programs. The themes included characteristics of the listeners (age, locality, occupation), indicators of behaviour change, testimonials, evidence of behaviour change, challenges and suggestions made.



**Strengths of the survey:** Primary and secondary data collection providing a historical, longitudinal understanding together with real time experience.

**Limitations:** A limitation of the methodology was the non-random sampling, meaning the purposive selection of respondents limits the statistical generalizability of the results to the entire population, prioritizing depth of understanding instead. The sample size was also small. Another limitation was the limited tracking of TV and online platforms due to low digital penetration in the target areas, which restricted the ability to thoroughly monitor the effectiveness of video drama.

## Appendix 2: Story Outline

### ★ SHTUKA RADIO DRAMA SEASON 1 (Episodes 1–8)

Theme: Gender Equality, Parental Support, and School Attendance

**Episode 1:** Teachers convene a meeting with parents to advocate for equal division of household chores between boys and girls, emphasizing its impact on students' well-being and school performance. The topic is gender-equitable division of chores at home.

**Episode 2:** Nneka is burdened with domestic work while her brothers play freely, sparking a family debate about fairness. The focus is on unequal gender expectations in households.

**Episode 3:** Sada sneaks out and returns late, only to face harsh discipline from her mother. The episode highlights parent-child communication and adolescent safety.

**Episode 4:** On her way to school, Nneka narrowly avoids a boda boda accident and endures street harassment, raising concerns about girls' safety. The theme is road safety and gender-based harassment.

**Episode 5:** Nneka is caught by her teacher arriving at school on a boda boda and is questioned, reflecting on risky transport practices and peer pressure.

**Episode 6:** Rehema's friend faces ridicule from classmates and begins to question her place in school. The story addresses bullying, self-confidence, and school motivation.

**Episode 7:** Sada is sent to an unyago (initiation) ceremony without her consent, interrupting her education. The episode explores harmful cultural practices affecting girls' schooling.

**Episode 8:** Parents and teachers agree to work together in monitoring children's progress and supporting education at home. The message centers on community-school collaboration.

## ★ SHTUKA RADIO DRAMA SEASON 2 (Episodes 9–16)

**Theme:** Early Marriage, School Attendance, and Economic Pressure

**Episode 9:** Mnahene accepts bride price for his daughter Nneka without her consent or informing his wife. This episode deals with child marriage and parental betrayal.

**Episode 10:** Sada disappears and her mother learns she has been skipping school. The theme is truancy and the importance of parental awareness.

**Episode 11:** Students begin to question whether education truly benefits them, but Amina passionately defends its long-term value. This episode reframes the value of education for youth.

**Episode 12:** Nneka's father refuses to pay for school meals, leading to her exclusion. The topic is economic barriers to school retention.

**Episode 13:** A heated exchange arises over unpaid bride price, shedding light on gendered financial exploitation.

**Episode 14:** Despite resistance, Nneka stands firm in her desire to continue her education. This showcases girl agency and determination.

**Episode 15:** A classroom debate about girls' roles reveals deep societal divisions and sparks critical thinking. The theme is aspirations and breaking stereotypes.

**Episode 16:** Rehema suddenly goes missing, alarming the entire community and prompting a collective response. The focus is on violence against girls and the need for community accountability.

## ★ SHTUKA DRAMA SEASON 3 (Episodes 17–32)

**Theme:** Care Work, Gender Norms, Peer Pressure, and Protection

**Episode 17:** Rehema is withdrawn from school and sent to live with her grandmother, tasked with household work. This episode highlights interruption of education due to caregiving.

**Episode 18:** Struggling with rural life and domestic responsibilities, Rehema feels isolated and overwhelmed. The issue is overburdening girls with unpaid domestic work.

**Episode 19:** Rehema observes risky behavior among youth in the village, sensing a lack of adult supervision. The theme is community neglect and adolescent vulnerability.

**Episode 20:** After rumors circulate, returning girls face stigma and are mocked by peers. This episode addresses school re-entry stigma and peer judgment.

**Episode 21:** Rehema's brother taunts her for coming back to school, reflecting gender-based ridicule and challenges to girls' self-esteem.

**Episode 22:** Her father dismisses her academic dreams, believing girls shouldn't pursue education. The theme is paternal disregard for girls' education.

**Episode 23:** A dedicated teacher steps in to help Rehema return to school. This episode emphasizes school staff support and reintegration efforts.

**Episode 24:** The community meets to discuss and resolve Rehema's situation, advocating for her rights. The focus is on community dialogue and reintegration.

**Episode 25:** Boda boda riders debate their role in either harming or protecting schoolgirls. The topic is transport safety and community action.

**Episode 26:** Some boda riders commit to safeguarding girls and become allies in the movement. This episode introduces positive role models and allyship.

**Episode 27:** Peer groups mobilize to support girls returning to school and advocate against dropout. The theme is peer-led initiatives and collective action.

**Episode 28:** A school club stages a drama about gender equality and challenges to girls' education. The message is about using arts for change and student empowerment.

**Episode 29:** Nneka emerges as a youth leader and organizes an awareness campaign in her community. The focus is youth leadership and education advocacy.

**Episode 30:** Teachers begin making home visits to follow up on students at risk of dropping out. The topic is teacher outreach and supportive follow-up.

**Episode 31:** Parents form a local support group to address school barriers and keep girls learning. The emphasis is on parental collaboration and shared responsibility.

**Episode 32:** With the support of teachers, family, and community, Rehema returns to school and resumes her journey. The final episode celebrates restoration, resilience, and collective success.



## Video Drama

### 🌟 SHTUKA VIDEO DRAMA (Episodes 1–24)

**Theme:** Girls' Education, Gender Norms, Protection, Parental Support, and Economic Hardship

**Episode 1:** Nneka, Sada, Rehema, and Sadiki dream of bright futures, but Mzee Mnahene dismisses the idea of educating girls, preferring to marry Nneka off early.

**Topic:** Value of girls' education vs. harmful social norms (child marriage).

**Episode 2:** With parents away at the farm, Nneka and Sadiki are left to care for themselves under strict instructions, raising concerns about responsibility and household burden.

**Topic:** Burden of domestic responsibility on children, especially girls.

**Episode 3:** Sada is harassed on the street by Konde, a bodaboda rider, and accepts a lift despite warnings, exposing her to potential harm.

**Topic:** Peer pressure and vulnerability to sexual exploitation.

**Episode 4:** Sadiki misses school lunch due to unpaid fees, revealing how poverty and hunger affect concentration and participation.

**Topic:** Economic barriers to school participation.

**Episode 5:** With no food at home, Nneka takes charge, highlighting children's silent suffering under food insecurity.

**Topic:** Hidden child hunger and food insecurity.

**Episode 6:** Nneka tries to buy food on credit but is humiliated; a predatory man offers to help, showing how poverty can lead to exploitation.

**Topic:** Exploitation of vulnerable girls by older men ("sugar daddies").

**Episode 7:** Konde corners Sada and attempts to coerce her into sex, but a fellow boda boda rider intervenes.

**Topic:** Gender-based violence and positive male intervention.

**Episode 8:** Nneka accepts gifts from Bolingo in exchange for attention; Shuu steps in to warn her of the danger.

**Topic:** Transactional relationships and sexual grooming.

**Episode 9:** Shuu counsels Nneka, urging her to return to school and focus on her dreams instead of quick money.

**Topic:** Mentorship and girl empowerment.

**Episode 10:** Sadiki attempts to find work on a fishing boat to support himself, facing adult-like pressures.

**Topic:** Child labor and risk of dropping out.

**Episode 11:** After facing hardship at sea, Sadiki receives encouragement from Shamte to return to school.

**Topic:** Second chances and peer motivation.

**Episode 12:** Mzee Mnahene avoids responsibility and spends money in bars while neglecting school obligations.

**Topic:** Irresponsible male financial behavior and its impact on families.

**Episode 13:** Sada returns home late from dancing, lies to her mother, and is punished harshly, revealing a communication breakdown.

**Topic:** Parent-adolescent conflict and harsh discipline.

**Episode 14:** Sada runs away from home, leaving her mother shocked and regretful.

**Topic:** Emotional trauma and consequences of rejection.

**Episode 15:** A teacher visits Nneka's home and expresses concern about her learning barriers, advocating for more parental support.

**Topic:** School-home collaboration and teacher advocacy.

**Episode 16:** Mzee Mnahene's mismanagement of family finances results in tension and crisis with Mama Nneka.

**Topic:** Family stress due to financial mismanagement.

**Episode 17:** Nneka and Sadiki feel discouraged from returning to school as family tensions rise. Mzee Mnahene finalizes plans to sell Nneka into marriage.

**Topic:** Depression, family neglect, and child marriage arrangements.

**Episode 18:** Shuu mobilizes village leaders to protect Nneka. Mnahene is arrested for trying to marry her off illegally.

**Topic:** Community accountability against child marriage.

**Episode 19:** The teacher meets Mnahene and urges him to reprioritize his children's education and make better financial choices.

**Topic:** Financial literacy and prioritizing education.

**Episode 20:** Mama Nneka rejects Bolingo's offer to marry her daughter. Meanwhile, Sada, now pregnant, reconciles with her mother.

**Topic:** Protecting girls from exploitation and supportive parenting.

**Episode 21:** Mama Nneka pleads with the school to keep her children enrolled despite difficulties and pledges support.

**Topic:** Parental commitment to education continuity.

**Episode 22:** Mnahene humbles himself and agrees to support Nneka and Sadiki after realizing his mistakes.

**Topic:** Parental transformation and restorative action.

**Episode 23:** The family begins budgeting, guided by the teacher. Even Konde is held accountable by the boda boda association.

**Topic:** Budgeting, redemption, and collective action.

**Episode 24:** Nneka, Rehema, and Sada share hopes for a better future as Sada prepares to return to school after giving birth.

**Topic:** School reentry, resilience, and sisterhood.

## **Appendix 3: Useful links**

[Links to Video drama](#)

[Links to Radio drama](#)

[Links to Radio Programs](#)

[Links to Jingles](#)

[Links to Inception Report](#)

[Links to Strategy](#)

[Links to Rapid Assessment](#)

[Links to Mid Season Review](#)